

Josh McVey

Lead SDET & Test Architect · Build & Release Manager · Platform & Full-Stack

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SUMMARY

Lead SDET, test architect, and Build & Release Manager with 20+ years spanning QA strategy, test automation architecture, platform engineering, and software delivery. I own the pipelines that ship two robot operating systems and a full cloud application suite, and I stay hands-on — cutting versions, tags, and deployments alongside the team. Full-stack contributor on Opentrons AI; owner of authentication and authorization across all web products. I make AI-assisted development operational in production, and I improve how work gets done by reading the incentives, people, and technical debt underneath a problem.

CORE SKILLS

Build, Release & Platform	CI/CD, GitHub Actions, AWS, release orchestration, versioning & tagging, Docker, Kubernetes / OpenShift, Helm, Datadog observability, Developer Experience
Quality Engineering	Lead SDET, test architecture & strategy, test framework design, API testing, BDD/TDD, UAT automation, pytest, Playwright/Puppeteer, Selenium, continuous testing
Languages & Full-Stack	Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, Java, C#, Groovy; OAuth/OIDC, GraphQL, REST, PostgreSQL, Node, Astro
AI-Augmented Delivery	Claude Code, Cursor, Warp; authoring skills, rules & repeatable workflows; AI feature delivery; OpenAI / AWS Amplify integrations; robot-interaction clients
Leadership	Build & Release management, cross-team release coordination, mentoring, architecture facilitation, process repair, product & design partnership

EXPERIENCE

Opentrons Labworks Feb 2024 – Present

Lead Software Engineer & Build & Release Manager

Remote (HQ: Long Island City, NY)

- Own Build & Release for two robot operating systems and the full Opentrons application suite — hands-on for every version, tag, and deployment while leading the team that ships them.
- Drive delivery improvements org-wide: streamlined release processes, stronger test automation, and cross-team coordination that shortened robot software release cycles.
- Full-stack engineer on Opentrons AI; own authentication and authorization (OAuth/OIDC) across all web products.
- Made AI-assisted development operational for the team — authored skills, rules, and workflows and shipped AI features and TypeScript/Python robot-interaction clients.

Opentrons Labworks Jun 2021 – Present

Senior Developer & SDET

Remote (HQ: Long Island City, NY)

- Architect, build, and operate the Protocol Library (library.opentrons.com) and Opentrons Accounts — acting as project manager, architect, and lead developer.
- Built CI/CD on GitHub Actions and AWS and testing frameworks that made robot software releases faster and more reliable.
- Stood up Datadog monitoring and proactive incident detection for high availability across cloud services.
- Partnered across product, QA, and engineering to coordinate releases and resolve issues quickly.

TEKsystems Aug 2019 – Jun 2021

Test Automation Architect — Continuous Testing Practice

Remote

- Practice architect for continuous testing across client engagements.
- Led pytest-based feature automation for a gaming-engine team of 10 (Python).

- Led browser-based UAT in Azure DevOps for energy-sector .com work, directing a team of 5 (JavaScript/TypeScript).

Rackspace

Nov 2016 – Aug 2019

Software Developer, Test III (Lead SDET)

Remote

- Lead SDET on a dedicated-device web portal spanning customer-facing web apps, ETL pipelines, and APIs; contributed across code, review, planning, and team leadership.
- Automation and services in Python (pytest, requests, Selenium), Java (TestNG, RestAssured), TypeScript (Ava, Puppeteer), and Groovy (Grails, Spock).
- Delivery stack: Jenkins, OpenShift/Kubernetes, Helm, Docker, GraphQL, StreamSets, Elasticsearch.

Xpanxion

Dec 2009 – Nov 2016

Test Architect · Lead Automation Engineer · Automation Test Lead / Manager

Remote / Kearney, NE

- Hands-on QA strategy and automation consultant on long-term, strategic engagements; directed QA for the business unit of a top client.
- Authored automation frameworks for web, web services, ETL, mobile, and desktop; BDD/TDD with Cucumber-JVM, JUnit, TestNG, NUnit, MSTest.
- Performance testing with LoadRunner and JMeter; recruited, onboarded, and mentored QA engineers and teams.

Earlier roles

2003 – 2013

Epiq Systems · Standard Beverage · Target · Independent IT

Kansas / Nebraska

- Epiq Systems (Software Automation Engineer): C# unit-test and coded-UI automation for web and desktop applications.
- Standard Beverage (Junior Developer): ASP.NET/VB.NET business applications, operations dashboards, and DB2 / SQL Server database design.
- Target (Group Leader): operations leadership for a 500-associate facility — took a team from worst to first in productivity and quality while underspending payroll plan 5–25%.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Kansas State University

1996 – 2003

B.S., Physical Sciences

- ISTQB Certified Tester, Foundation Level (CTFL)